

REPORT & PROPOSAL — TO LEADERSHIP

A UNIFIED BUILD GUIDELINE AND BIM STANDARD FOR ALL HALLS OF WORSHIP

REPORT REFERENCE	DATE	CLASSIFICATION
RPT-2026-GMF-001	04 July 2026	Proposal — For Leadership Review
PREPARED BY	DEPARTMENT	
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01. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report is respectfully submitted to the leadership of the Grail Message Foundation in Nigeria. It describes a recurring problem observed across our building projects — the absence of a single, unified project build guideline — and the unnecessary cost, delay and rework this has caused. It then presents a proposal in three parts: **(1)** the adoption of a unified Project Build Guideline for every Hall of Worship project in Nigeria, **(2)** a BIM (Building Information Modelling) standard so that every hall has one accurate digital model from which all drawings and quantities are produced, and **(3)** the progressive production of updated BIM models for the existing Halls of Worship, so that renovation and maintenance can be planned from accurate records rather than rediscovered on site.

Before anything else, we ask leadership one question: **does an approved building guideline already exist within the Foundation in Nigeria?** If it does, we ask for the opportunity to help

update it and to ensure it is passed along to every centre and Hall of Worship. If it does not, we ask for leadership's support and mandate to establish one. A complete draft framework has already been prepared and is ready for review.

02. BACKGROUND

There are several Halls of Worship across Nigeria, with more under construction and others requiring renovation or modification. Over more than two years of direct involvement in these projects, a consistent pattern has been observed: each project is planned, designed, costed and supervised in its own way, because there is no common guideline binding them together. The consequences have been unnecessary cost spending, difficulty in achieving project goals, and an overhaul burden in project supervision and control.

A recent, concrete example is the Hall of Worship, Osogbo (report **RPT-2026-OSG-001**, 02 July 2026). The altar was built wrong compared to the standard to which it should be done — and this is a major issue across all the projects we have been involved in. The resulting remodification — altar steps, side-wall structural changes, ceiling and partition works — is estimated at **₦16,137,000**. A significant portion of that sum is not new value: this is precisely the class of cost that a unified guideline and accurate building models are designed to prevent.

03. THE PROBLEM — FINDINGS

- 01** There is no unified build guideline in use across projects (or, if one exists, it is not reaching the centres). Each project team improvises its own process for budgeting, contractor selection, supervision and reporting, so quality and cost control depend entirely on who happens to be involved.
- 02** Drawings and site reality drift apart. Without a single controlled model as the source of truth, plans, sections and schedules are produced separately and disagree — and buildings end up differing from their own approved drawings, as seen at Osogbo. Every later modification then begins with expensive re-measurement and demolition of work already paid for.
- 03** Costs overrun because changes are informal. Verbal variations, quantities estimated rather than measured, and payments not tied to certified work make the final cost of a project unpredictable and difficult to defend.

- 04

Supervision and control are inconsistent. There is no common standard for site reporting, inspections before cover-up, or materials verification, so defects are discovered late — when correction is most expensive.
- 05

Existing halls have no up-to-date as-built records or BIM models. Renovation and maintenance must therefore start from scratch each time, and designs and lessons from one hall cannot be reused to make the next hall faster and cheaper.

04. OUR REQUEST TO LEADERSHIP

1.

Is there an existing guideline? — If the Foundation already has an approved building or project guideline in Nigeria, we respectfully ask that it be made available to the Projects team, so we can help review and update it to current realities (material prices, BIM technology, supervision practice) and ensure it is formally passed along to every centre and Hall of Worship project.
2.

If none exists, we ask for leadership's support and mandate to establish the unified framework proposed in Section 05. The draft documents are already prepared; what is needed is leadership's review, adoption, and a directive that all centres follow one guide.
3.

Approval in principle for as-built BIM models of the existing halls — produced progressively, prioritising halls likely to be renovated or extended, so that future works are planned from accurate records (Section 06).

05. THE PROPOSAL — A UNIFIED FRAMEWORK

A complete draft framework has been prepared and is ready for leadership's review. It consists of five guideline documents and four working templates, summarised below.

TABLE 1 — PROPOSED GUIDELINE DOCUMENTS (DRAFTS COMPLETED)

#	Document	What it establishes
1	Project Build Guideline GMF-PG-001	Six project phases from initiation to handover, each closed by a documented gate approval; defined roles (Project Board, Project Manager, Architect, Quantity Surveyor, Site Supervisor); separation of the person who certifies work from the person who approves payment; a monthly reporting rhythm to leadership.

2	BIM Guideline GMF-BIM-001	One digital model per hall as the single source of truth. All drawings, schedules and quantities are extracted from the model — they can never disagree with each other. Naming conventions, level of detail per phase, archive formats, and a growing template library so each new hall starts from proven designs.
3	Cost Management & Procurement GMF-CM-001	Estimates with defined accuracy at each approval gate; Bill of Quantities taken off the model; minimum three bids for major works; written change orders only — no verbal variations; retention and defects liability on every contract; monthly cost forecast to leadership.
4	Quality & Supervision Standard GMF-QS-001	Nine mandatory hold points (setting-out, foundations, every structural pour, roof, services before cover-up) that must be inspected and released in writing before work proceeds; SON-compliant materials with certificates; daily site diary and weekly photographic reports.
5	Hall of Worship Registry GMF-HR-001	One register of every hall — completed, under construction and planned — each with a project code, status and link to its documents, so leadership always has a single national overview.

Supporting templates already prepared: Project Charter, Weekly Site Report, Change Order, and Hold-Point Inspection Checklist — ready for immediate use once the framework is adopted.

06. BIM MODELS FOR EXISTING HALLS OF WORSHIP

We propose that every existing Hall of Worship progressively receives an **updated as-built BIM model** — a measured, accurate digital model of the hall as it actually stands. This pays for itself in three ways:

- 1. Reference for new projects** — a modelled hall becomes a template. Seating layouts, altar arrangements, roof structures and finishes that already work are reused, so a new project starts at an advanced stage instead of from a blank page.
- 2. Renovation without surprises** — the Osogbo experience shows what it costs when works are planned from drawings that no longer match the building. With an as-built model, the scope and quantities of any modification are measured before a single block is broken.

3. Easier maintenance — equipment, services routes and finishes are recorded in one place, so repairs are planned, budgeted and executed faster, by whoever is serving at the time.

Modelling would be prioritised: first, halls with works currently planned or likely; then halls in active use with ageing services; then the remainder as resources allow.

07. EXPECTED BENEFITS

TABLE 2 — WHAT CHANGES WITH A UNIFIED GUIDELINE

Today (without a guideline)	With the unified framework
Buildings drift from their drawings.	One controlled model per hall; drawings and site verified against it at fixed inspection points — revisions and remodifications are greatly reduced.
Costs are unpredictable; changes happen verbally and surface later in the account.	Every change is priced and approved in writing before execution; leadership sees a monthly forecast of final cost, not a surprise at the end.
Each project reinvents its own process; quality depends on individuals.	Every centre follows the same phases, approvals and standards; supervision is consistent nationwide.
Renovation and maintenance of existing halls start from zero information.	As-built BIM models make renovation and maintenance measurable, plannable and cheaper to undertake.
Experience leaves with the people who carried it.	Benchmark costs, designs and lessons are recorded after every project and reused on the next.

08. PROPOSED NEXT STEPS

1. Leadership confirms whether an existing guideline is in place, and nominates a small committee to review the prepared draft framework (or reconcile it with the existing guideline).
2. The framework is adopted with any amendments, and formally communicated to every centre and Hall of Worship project as the standard to follow.
3. All new and ongoing projects are registered in the Hall of Worship Registry and brought under the guideline at their current stage.

4. As-built BIM modelling of existing halls begins with the highest-priority halls (those with works planned or expected).
5. The guideline is reviewed after the first full project cycle and improved from recorded lessons.

09. CONCLUSION

The Foundation's halls deserve to be built well, built once, and cared for with foresight. The problems described here are not failures of dedication — they are the predictable result of working without a common guide. The remedy is ready: a unified build guideline, a single accurate model for every hall, and updated records for the halls we already have. We respectfully ask leadership to confirm whether an existing guideline is in place, and — whether by updating it or adopting the prepared framework — to lend its support and authority so that every future project is delivered to one standard, with fewer revisions, less remodification, and real savings in cost.

AUTHORISATION

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